

Russia thwarts plans to turn Kazakhstan "into another Libya or Syria"

Russia's deployment of its peacekeeping forces to Kazakhstan – in response to the Central Asian country's request following an attack by terrorist groups – sparked outrage in the West, which does not even recognize Moscow's right to move its troops through national territory, nor its right to have its own sphere of influence.

This anger has absolutely no basis, according to Guadi Calvo, a specialist in Asia, the Middle East and Africa, who told Sputnik that "Russia has the right to get involved in the issue of Kazakhstan, because it shares a 7,500-kilometer border with that country, in addition to the political and economic ties that both nations maintain."

He also emphasized that Russia and other countries that are part of the Collective Security Treaty Organization (CSTO) deployed their contingents at the request of Kazakh President Kassym-Jomart Tokayev, and that the speed of the assistance provided made it possible to "almost resolve the Kazakhstan issue."

Calvo expressed his conviction that the US was behind the violence unleashed in Kazakhstan, where the plan was to turn the country into a terrorist enclave – in fact, the beheadings of police officers carried out amid the riots are typical actions of "organizations like Daesh and Al Qaeda [outlawed in Russia]" – to create a major headache for both Russia and China.

"How can Russia allow a Libya or a Syria on its borders? Russia is a power and acts like a power, and it cannot allow that kind of thing," he pointed out.

He also pointed out that the destabilization of Kazakhstan was intended to undermine the Chinese project of the New Silk Road, where one of its railway sections will connect the Asian giant with Russia through Kazakh territory.

Furthermore, Calvo denounced the hypocrisy of Washington and its allies in questioning **the legitimacy of Russia's actions**, asking "what right does the US have to intervene" in countries like Niger, Libya, Somalia, Ethiopia, Afghanistan or Yemen, among many others, without sharing borders with these nations, and without asking for any authorization.